Rebuttal to Argument in Favor of Fresno County Transient Occupancy Tax Measure

Fresno County

November 3, 2026 Consolidated Statewide General Election

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Text of Argument Below This Line

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By. DEPUTY

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Transitory occupancy taxes may sound like only visitors will pay them, but they actually hurt **local** people and small businesses because they increase costs and drive visitors away.

Small hotel and rental owners often cannot raise their prices to cover a new tax. If the prices are too high, visitors will simply choose a cheaper place to stay. That means owners must keep prices low and pay the tax themselves, which makes it harder to stay open, hire workers, or improve their property.

A sudden jump from **no tax to a high tax like 12% overnight** is especially harmful. Businesses cannot adjust their prices, budgets, or marketing fast enough. Visitors planning trips will see the big price increase and pick another area outside Fresno County. When they stay elsewhere, the money they spend on food, gas, shops, and entertainment go to that other community, too. Our region loses out.

Instead of letting businesses compete fairly, the government forces prices up in a way owners cannot control. Big hotel chains can absorb the cost, but small local owners cannot.

Even though the tax targets visitors, residents feel the impact. Fewer visitors means fewer jobs, fewer customers for local stores, and less money circulating in the community.

In the end, a sudden 12% occupancy tax pushes visitors away, hurts small businesses, and weakens the local economy.

Don't reward poor monetary management and budget decisions with a new (forever) tax!

Say NO to new taxes. Say NO to MEASURE __

https://lpfresno.org/NoHotelTax

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DECLARATION BY AUTHOR(S) OF ARGUMENTS OR REBUTTALS

(E.C. §9600)

All arguments concerning measures filed pursuant to Division 9 of the Elections Code shall be accompanied by the following declaration to be signed by each author of the argument/rebuttal. Names and titles will be printed in the Voter Pamphlet portion of the County Voter Information Guide in the order provided below.

The undersigned author(s) of the: ☐Argument in Favor ☒Rebuttal to Argument in Favor ☐Argument Against ☐Rebuttal to Argument Against

of ballot measure Fresno County Transient Occupancy Tax Measure (Name and/or Letter) at the Consolidated Statewide General Election (Title of Election)

for the Fresno County (Jurisdiction) to be held on November 3, 2026 (Date) hereby state that this argument is true and correct to the best of his/her/their knowledge and belief.

1.	Francisco Alanis (Printed Name) Chair, Libertarian Party of Fresno County (Title to Appear on Argument)	(Signature) 7/21/26 (Date)	
2.	Kat McElroy (Printed Name) Vice Chair, Libertarian Party of Fresno County (Title to Appear on Argument)	(Signature) 8/3/26 (Date)	
3.	(Printed Name) (Title to Appear on Argument)	(Signature) (Date)	
4.	(Printed Name) (Title to Appear on Argument)	(Signature) (Date)	
5.	(Printed Name) (Title to Appear on Argument)	(Signature) (Date)	

IMPORTANT FILING INFORMATION: I, Kat McElroy (Printed Name) _____ am the designated filer of the above titled argument/rebuttal. Please notify me of any questions pertaining to this filing. Below is my contact information.

Mailing Address: PO Box 161, Raisin City, CA 93652 E-Mail Address: vicechair@lpfresno.org

Contact Numbers: 559-785-0810 (Daytime) 559-785-0810 (Evening) _____ (Fax)

To be completed for arguments filed by the governing body or bona fide association of citizens.

ARGUMENT/REBUTTAL FILED BY (Check any of the following that apply):

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A. **Governing Body**

☐ **Board of Supervisors**

☐ **District Board**

Contact Person's Signature: _____

Contact Person's Name (Printed): _____

Title: _____

Phone: _____ Fax: _____ E-mail: _____

B. **The following information is submitted by the author(s) to establish that the organization or group is a Bona Fide Association of Citizens**

☑ **Bona Fide Association of Citizens (Group or organization has not been formed to support or oppose the measure)**

Name of Association: Libertarian Party of Fresno County

Principal Officer's Signature: _____

Principal Officer's Name (Printed): Kat McElroy

Title: Vice Chair

Phone: 559-785-0810 Fax: _____ E-mail: vicechair@lpfresno.org

☐ **Bona Fide Association of Citizens (Group or organization has been formed to support or oppose the measure)**

Name of Association: _____

Principal Officer's Signature: _____

Principal Officer's Name (Printed): _____

Title: _____

Phone: _____ Fax: _____ E-mail: _____